



City of Cambridge

POR 2026-129
FIRST IN COUNCIL
June 22, 2026

VICE MAYOR AZEEM
COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN

- WHEREAS: Traffic safety is fundamental to ensuring that Cambridge's streets are safe and accessible for all; and
- WHEREAS: The Cambridge Police Department provides citation data through the City of Cambridge's [open data portal](#); and
- WHEREAS: Analysis of that data reveals a sustained decline in traffic citations, approximating a decline of about 57% from the peak year of 2014, across nearly every category of moving violation; and
- WHEREAS: The most dramatic decline in categories of violations are in unsafe door opening, speeding, crosswalk violations, failure to stop or yield and blocking a bike lane; and
- WHEREAS: By contrast, other citation categories, such as bicycle violations and texting while driving, have declined comparatively less; and
- WHEREAS: The City Council has a responsibility to understand the causes of this trend and to ensure that enforcement policy reflects the City's stated commitments to Vision Zero and the safety of all road users; now therefore be it
- ORDERED: That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to direct the Cambridge Police Department to prepare a report for the City Council regarding the causes of the significant decline in traffic enforcement since 2015, current departmental priorities, and recommendations for enforcement; and be it further
- ORDERED: That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to report back to the City Council with this overview and set of recommendations.

A true copy;

ATTEST:-

A handwritten signature in cursive script, reading "Paula M. Crane".

Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk



City of Cambridge

That the City Manager is requested to direct the Cambridge Police Department to prepare a report for the City Council regarding the causes of the significant decline in traffic enforcement since 2015, current departmental priorities, and recommendations for enforcement.